

SCHEDULED TRIBE EDUCATIONAL LITERACY AUDIT

Union Territory of Dadra & Nagar Haveli

A Data-Driven Review of Literacy Among Varli, Kokna & Dhodia Children (Age 0–14) — Census 2001

Prepared by	Manisha Singh
Report Date	July 20, 2026
Data Source	Census of India, 2001 — ST Educational Data (data.gov.in)
Tools Used	Microsoft Excel (Data Cleaning & Pivot Analysis); Microsoft Power BI (Interactive Dashboard)
Scope	Varli, Kokna & Dhodia tribes Age group 0–14

1. Introduction

Education is a cornerstone of community welfare and social justice. Scheduled Tribe (ST) communities in India frequently face structural barriers to education arising from geographic isolation, economic marginalisation, and limited institutional outreach. This report presents a performance-oriented audit of literacy outcomes among the three major ST communities of Dadra & Nagar Haveli — Varli, Kokna, and Dhodia — with a specific focus on children aged 0–14, the population segment most directly governed by India's Right to Education framework.

The analysis is grounded in Article 21A (Right to Education), Article 45 (Provision for Early Childhood Care and Education), and Article 46 (Promotion of Educational and Economic Interests of Scheduled Tribes) of the Constitution of India. By visualising Census 2001 data across age, gender, and rural–urban dimensions, this audit aims to surface the specific literacy gaps that most urgently require policy attention under the Directive Principles of State Policy (DPSP).

1.1 Methodology

- Data Source: Census-based Scheduled Tribe educational data (data.gov.in), Census of India 2001.
- Tools: Microsoft Excel (data cleaning, pivot-table analysis, and chart-based visualisation); Microsoft Power BI (interactive, filterable dashboard reproducing the same findings for stakeholder review).
- Techniques: Comparative cross-tribe analysis, gender-disaggregated data processing, age-cohort trend interpretation, and rural–urban segmentation.

1.2 Objectives

- To audit literacy trends among tribal children aged 0–14.
- To compare educational performance across the Varli, Kokna, and Dhodia tribes.
- To highlight gender-based literacy disparities within each community.
- To examine the rural–urban distribution of each tribe and its bearing on literacy outcomes.
- To map educational outcomes against constitutional mandates and existing government schemes.

1.3 Study Area Selection

Dadra & Nagar Haveli was selected as the focus of this audit on the basis of both its demographic profile and its administrative characteristics. As per Census 2001, Scheduled Tribes constituted approximately 62.2% of the Union Territory's total population (137,225 of 220,490 persons) — a tribal majority that is unusual among Indian states and Union Territories and makes DNH a setting where ST educational outcomes are effectively the mainstream education outcome for the territory, not a minority sub-issue. This gives any literacy audit here direct and immediate policy relevance.

DNH's relatively compact geographic and administrative scale — 491 sq. km across 72 villages, under direct Central Government administration — also makes community-level analysis practically feasible in a way that is harder to achieve in larger or more dispersed jurisdictions. This distinguishes it from island Union Territories such as the Andaman & Nicobar Islands, where the Scheduled Tribe population is both a much smaller share of the total population and includes several small, geographically isolated and, in some cases, Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs) with fundamentally different administrative, logistical, and data-comparability considerations than a mainland, settled tribal population. DNH's profile — a tribal-majority, mainland, single-administration territory with a small number of large, well-enumerated tribal communities — offered the most tractable and policy-relevant setting for this particular audit.

1.4 Composition of the Scheduled Tribe Population and Rationale for Tribe Selection

Within DNH's ST population, three communities dominate numerically. Varli is by far the largest, constituting approximately 62.94% of the Union Territory's tribal population, followed by Dhodia at 16.90% and Kokna at 16.85%. Together, these three tribes account for approximately 96.69% of the tribal population, making them the natural and near-exhaustive unit of analysis for any tribe-level literacy audit of this Union Territory.

The remaining Scheduled Tribes — Dubla (2.29%), Kolgha (0.84%), Kathodi (0.08%) and Naika (0.08%) — collectively constitute the balance of about 3.31% of the tribal population. These communities were not analysed individually in this audit: at this population scale, age- and gender-disaggregated breakdowns would rest on very small sample sizes, making tribe-specific literacy rates statistically unstable and unsuitable for policy conclusions. Restricting the audit to Varli, Kokna, and Dhodia therefore captures the overwhelming majority of tribal children in the Union Territory while ensuring that every finding in this report rests on a demographically substantial and statistically reliable base.

2. Comparative Literacy Status Across Tribes

The table below summarises total, literate, and illiterate population figures for children aged 0–14 across the three tribes, drawn from the consolidated workbook.

Tribe	Total Persons	Literate Persons	Illiterate Persons	Literacy %	Illiteracy %
Varli	40,002	11,803	28,199	29.51%	70.49%
Dhodia	6,583	3,213	3,370	48.81%	51.19%
Kokna	8,721	3,477	5,244	39.87%	60.13%

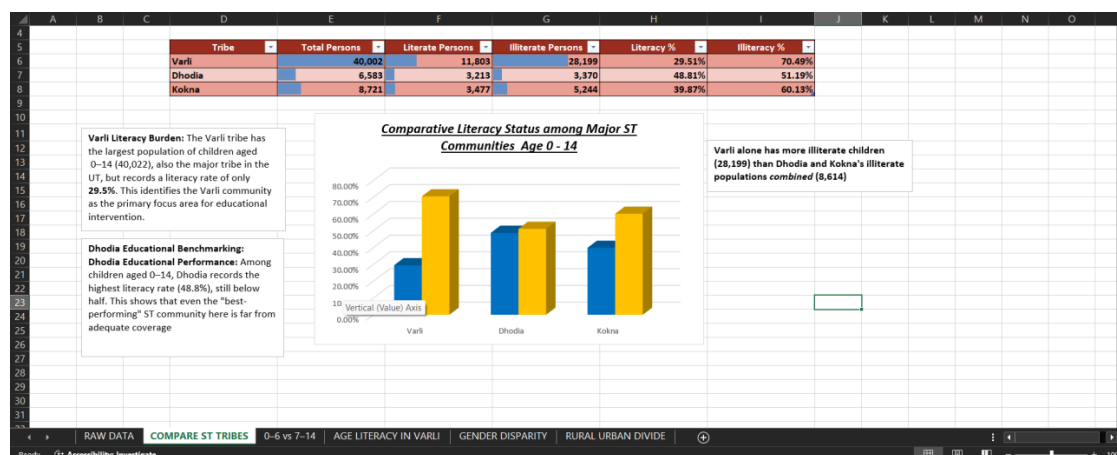


Figure 1: Comparative literacy status among major ST communities (source workbook, sheet "Compare ST Tribes")

2.1 Key Observation — Varli's Literacy Burden

Varli is by far the largest tribal group in the Union Territory, accounting for 40,002 of the roughly 55,000 tribal children aged 0–14 covered in this audit — over 72% of the combined population. Yet its literacy rate of only 29.51% is the lowest of the three tribes. In absolute terms, Varli's 28,199 illiterate children outnumber the combined illiterate populations of Dhodia and Kokna (8,614) by more than three to one. This scale effect makes Varli the single most consequential community for any literacy intervention in the Union Territory: even modest percentage-point gains here would move more children into literacy than a full turnaround in either of the smaller tribes.

2.2 Key Observation — Dhodia's Relative Performance

Dhodia records the highest literacy rate among the three tribes at 48.81%, roughly 9 points above Kokna and nearly 20 points above Varli. Even so, fewer than half of Dhodia's children aged 0–14 are literate, which indicates that while Dhodia is the strongest performer in relative terms, no tribe in this audit has achieved adequate educational coverage by absolute standards.

3. Age-Band Analysis: 0–6 vs 7–14

Splitting the population into the Census-defined pre-primary band (0–6) and the primary/upper-primary band (7–14) isolates where the literacy gap is structural (applying to all tribes equally) versus where it is tribe-specific.

Tribe	0–6 Population	0–6 Literacy %	7–14 Population	7–14 Literate	7–14 Literacy %
Varli	20,505	0%	19,497	11,803	60.50%
Dhodia	3,131	0%	3,452	3,213	93.10%
Kokna	4,354	0%	4,367	3,477	79.60%

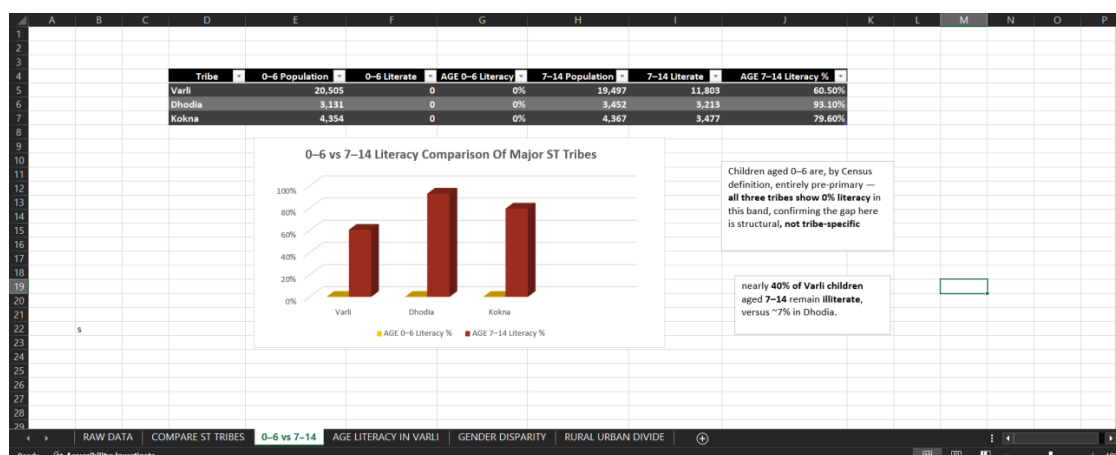


Figure 2: 0–6 vs 7–14 literacy comparison across major ST tribes (source workbook, sheet "0–6 vs 7–14")

Children aged 0–6 show 0% literacy across all three tribes without exception. This is consistent with the Census definition of literacy, which is not typically assessed below school-entry age, and confirms that this segment of the gap is structural rather than tribe-specific — it points instead to the need for stronger Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE) coverage under Article 45, ahead of formal schooling.

Within the 7–14 band, the picture diverges sharply by tribe. Dhodia's 7–14 literacy rate of 93.10% is close to universal, Kokna sits at a moderate 79.60%, while Varli trails at 60.50% — roughly 33 percentage points behind Dhodia. This gap, unlike the 0–6 gap, is tribe-specific and reflects differences in schooling access, retention, or community-level engagement with formal education once children reach school-going age.

4. Age-Wise Literacy Trend — Varli Tribe

Because Varli carries the largest share of illiterate children in the Union Territory, its age-wise literacy trajectory was examined in further detail to identify the specific ages at which literacy gains are made and subsequently lost.

Age	Illiterate	Literate	Total Population	Literacy %
0–6	20,505	0	20,505	0%
7	1,221	1,208	2,429	50%
8	1,203	1,881	3,084	61%
9	696	1,533	2,229	69%
10	1,318	1,984	3,302	60%
11	487	1,213	1,700	71%
12	1,156	1,720	2,876	60%
13	694	1,133	1,827	62%
14	919	1,131	2,050	55%

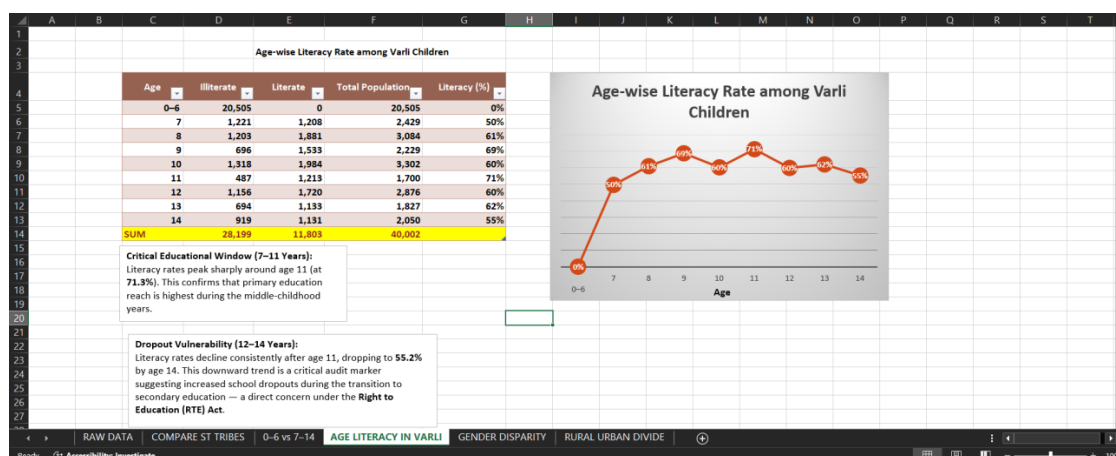


Figure 3: Age-wise literacy rate among Varli children, 0–14 (source workbook, sheet "Age Literacy in Varli")

4.1 Critical Educational Window (7–11 Years)

Literacy climbs sharply from 0% at age 6 to 50% at age 7, and continues rising through middle childhood, peaking at 71% at age 11. This confirms that primary-education reach among Varli children is at its strongest during these middle-childhood years, likely reflecting the cumulative effect of several years of primary schooling by that point.

4.2 Dropout Vulnerability (12–14 Years)

From age 11 onward, literacy rates decline consistently — from 71% at age 11 to 55% by age 14. This downward trend, rather than a data anomaly, is a critical audit marker: it suggests rising school dropout during the transition from primary to upper-primary/secondary schooling, a pattern directly relevant to enforcement of the Right to Education (RTE) Act, which mandates free and compulsory education up to age 14.

5. Gender Disparity in Literacy

Literacy was further disaggregated by gender for each tribe to assess whether educational gaps are shared equally between boys and girls.

Tribe	Male Literacy %	Female Literacy %	Gender Gap (points)
Varli	36.70%	22.10%	14.6
Kokna	44.20%	35.60%	8.7
Dhodia	49.30%	48.30%	1.0

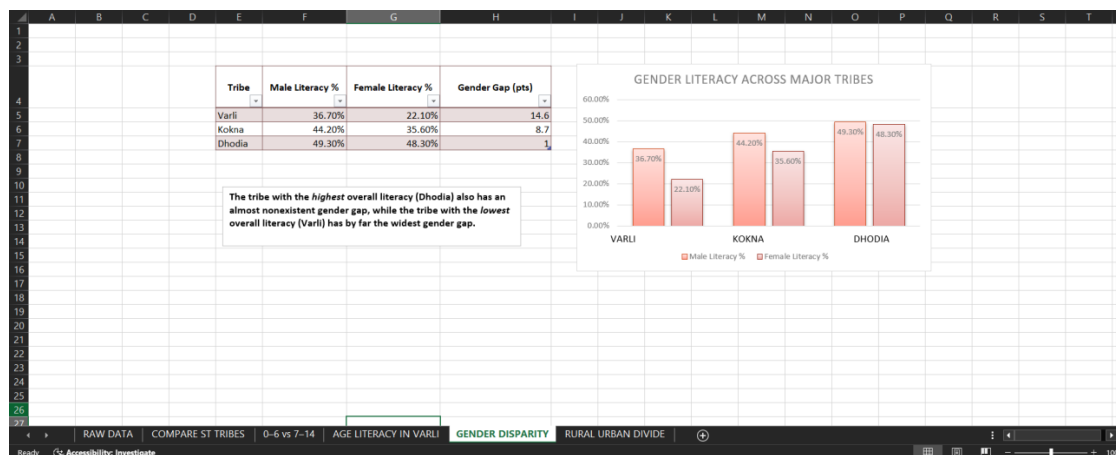


Figure 4: Gender literacy comparison across major tribes (source workbook, sheet "Gender Disparity")

Male literacy is consistently higher than female literacy across every tribe, but the size of the gap varies considerably. Dhodia — the tribe with the highest overall literacy — has an almost negligible gender gap of just 1.0 point, with female literacy (48.30%) nearly matching male literacy (49.30%). Varli, the tribe with the lowest overall literacy, has by far the widest gender gap at 14.6 points, with female literacy at only 22.10% against male literacy of 36.70%. Kokna falls in between, with an 8.7-point gap.

This pattern suggests that overall educational attainment and gender equity in education move together in this data: communities that invest more broadly in schooling also tend to close the gender gap, while communities with weaker overall literacy leave girls furthest behind.

6. Rural–Urban Divide (Ages 0–14)

Given the well-documented link between urbanisation and school access, the rural–urban population split was examined for each tribe.

Tribe	Rural Population	Urban Population	Rural %	Urban %
Varli	38,618	1,384	96.50%	3.50%
Dhodia	4,800	1,783	72.90%	27.10%
Kokna	8,646	75	99.10%	0.90%

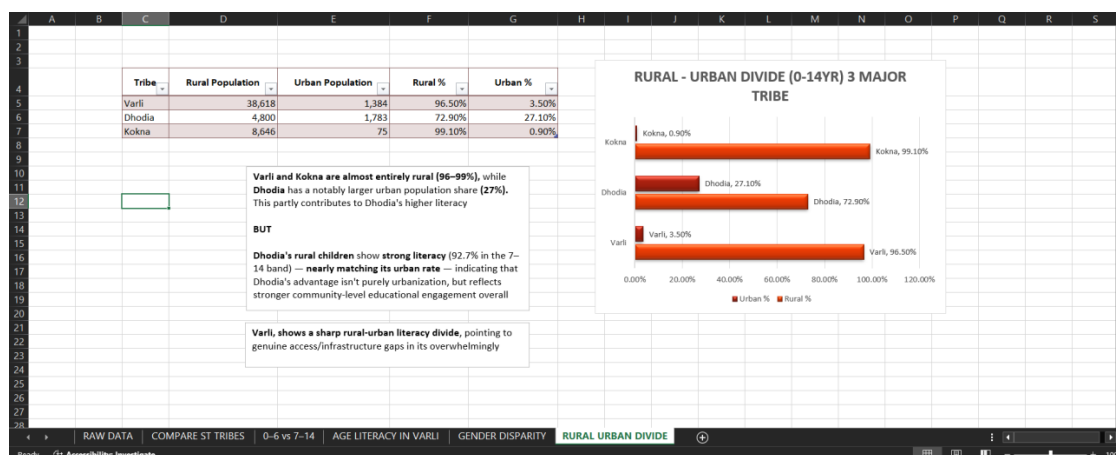


Figure 5: Rural–urban divide among major ST tribes, ages 0–14 (source workbook, sheet "Rural Urban Divide")

Varli and Kokna children are almost entirely rural (96.5% and 99.1% respectively), while Dhodia has a markedly larger urban population share at 27.1%. This urban presence partly explains Dhodia's stronger literacy performance. However, urbanisation is not the whole story: Dhodia's rural children alone still show strong literacy in the 7–14 band (approximately 92.7%), nearly matching the tribe's urban rate — indicating that Dhodia's advantage reflects genuinely stronger community-level educational engagement, not merely better access to city infrastructure.

Varli, by contrast, shows a sharp rural–urban literacy divide, which — combined with its near-total rural concentration — points to genuine access and infrastructure gaps in the rural foothill areas where the tribe is predominantly located.

7. Policy & Constitutional Linkage

This audit's findings connect directly to the following constitutional provisions and government schemes:

- Constitutional Articles: 21A (Right to Education), 45 (Early Childhood Care and Education), and 46 (Promotion of Educational Interests of Scheduled Tribes).
- Government Schemes: Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan, Eklavya Model Residential Schools (EMRS), and Beti Bachao Beti Padhao.

7.1 Recommendations

- Strengthen Retention: Implement dropout-tracking for children aged 11–14, the age band where Varli literacy gains begin to reverse.
- Prioritise Varli: Direct the largest share of intervention resources toward Varli, given both its population scale and its lowest literacy rate among the three tribes.
- Gender-Focused Outreach: Launch localised incentive schemes for girl-child education specifically in Varli-concentrated areas, where the gender gap is widest.
- Rural Infrastructure: Improve access to primary schooling in rural tribal foothill regions, particularly for the near-entirely-rural Varli and Kokna populations.
- ECCE Expansion: Expand early childhood care coverage for the 0–6 age band across all three tribes, where literacy is uniformly at 0%.

7.2 Cross-Cutting Policy Insights

Read together, the findings in Sections 2–6 support several broader policy observations that go beyond any single chapter:

- **Intervention Priority:** Varli should be treated as the highest-priority community for intervention, as it simultaneously combines the largest child population, the lowest literacy rate, and the widest gender gap of the three tribes — a convergence of risk factors that is rare and significant.
- **Absolute vs Relative Burden:** Varli alone accounts for the overwhelming majority of illiterate children in this audit (28,199, versus 8,614 for Dhodia and Kokna combined). Because government resource allocation is typically driven by absolute impact rather than percentage-point comparisons, even a modest improvement in Varli's literacy rate is likely to benefit more children in absolute terms than a much larger relative improvement in either smaller tribe.
- **Educational Pipeline Leakage:** The age-wise pattern observed in Varli — literacy rising through age 11 and then declining through age 14 — suggests possible leakage in the educational pipeline during the transition from primary to upper-primary schooling. The data cannot establish the cause with certainty, but the pattern is consistent with rising dropout at this transition point.
- **Equality of Provision vs Equality of Outcome:** All three tribes fall under the same constitutional protections and the same government schemes, yet their literacy outcomes differ by as much as 20 percentage points. This indicates that equal constitutional and legal protection does not, by itself, guarantee comparable educational outcomes across communities.
- **Gender and Overall Literacy:** Higher overall literacy is associated with a smaller gender gap in this dataset — Dhodia, the highest-literacy tribe, has the narrowest gender gap (1.0 point), while Varli, the lowest-literacy tribe, has the widest (14.6 points). This is a correlation observed in the data rather than a demonstrated causal relationship, but it suggests that broad-based educational investment and gender-equity outcomes may move together.
- **Rurality Alone Does Not Explain Outcomes:** Dhodia's comparatively strong literacy performance despite a substantially rural population (72.9%) suggests that rural location alone does not fully explain literacy outcomes in this dataset, since Varli and Kokna — both more rural than Dhodia — perform considerably worse. Other factors not captured directly in this dataset are likely to also be at play.
- **Early Childhood Opportunity:** Although Census literacy is, by definition, expected to be zero for the 0–6 age group, this uniform finding across all three tribes highlights a policy opportunity to strengthen Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE) ahead of formal schooling, as mandated under Article 45.
- **Constitutional Delivery Gap:** Despite constitutional guarantees under Articles 21A, 45, and 46, substantial and unevenly distributed literacy gaps persist across the three tribes. This pattern points toward implementation and delivery challenges in translating constitutional protections into outcomes, rather than an absence of legal protection.
- **Targeted Resource Allocation:** Given finite resources, concentrating educational investment in the highest-need community — Varli — is likely to yield a greater overall improvement in literacy than distributing the same resources uniformly across all three tribes.

8. Conclusion

This audit shows that while literacy improves meaningfully with age across all three tribes, significant and unevenly distributed gaps persist. The Varli tribe — the largest ST community in Dadra & Nagar Haveli — carries the greatest absolute burden of illiteracy and the widest gender gap, making it the clear priority for intervention. The consistent decline in literacy after age 11 across the data serves as an early-warning indicator that existing Right to Education implementation is not fully securing retention for tribal children, particularly girls. Targeted, tribe-specific, and gender-conscious educational support will be essential to close these constitutional delivery gaps.

9. Interactive Power BI Dashboard

To complement the static Excel-based analysis presented above, an interactive Power BI dashboard ("ST_Literacy_Dashboard") was developed on the same underlying Census 2001 dataset. The dashboard allows a reviewer to filter dynamically by tribe and age group and is organised across five linked pages: a title/overview page, an Overview page (headline literacy and population figures), an Age-wise Literacy Analysis page, a Gender Disparity Analysis page, and a Demographic Profile page covering the rural–urban split.

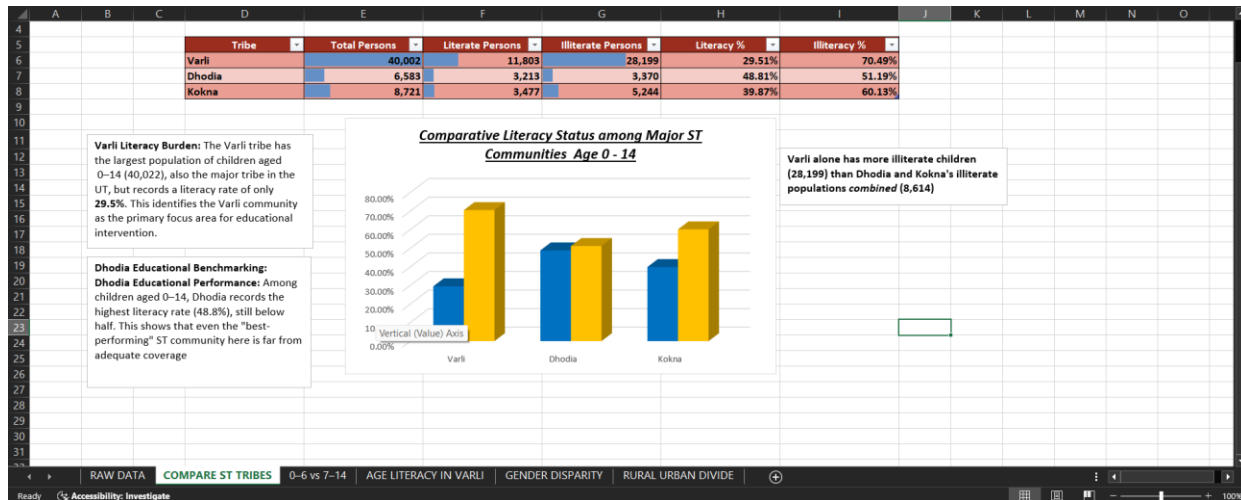
The dashboard reproduces and cross-validates every figure reported in Sections 2–6 of this document — for example, the 29.51% / 48.81% / 39.87% literacy rates for Varli, Dhodia, and Kokna respectively, and the rural-share figures of 96.5%, 72.9%, and 99.1% — while additionally allowing interactive drill-down that a static report cannot provide. Full-page screenshots of the dashboard are included in Appendix G–K.

Appendix: Source Workbook & Dashboard Screenshots

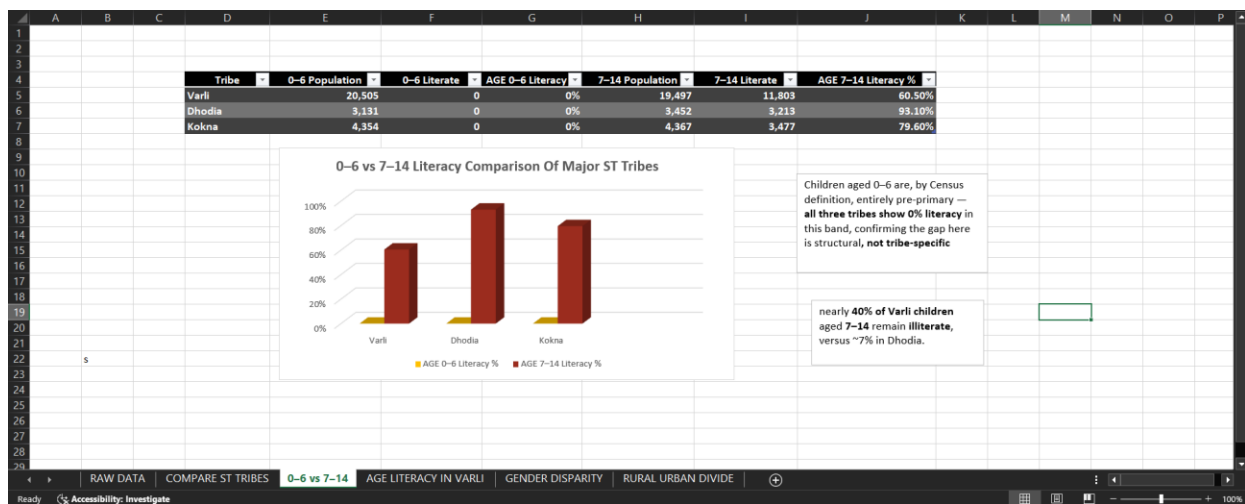
The following screenshots are provided as supporting evidence, showing the underlying Excel workbook ("Manisha_Singh_Data_Analysis_Workbook") and the accompanying Power BI dashboard ("ST_Literacy_Dashboard") from which all figures, tables, and charts in this report were drawn.

Area Name	ST Name	Total/Rural/Urban	Age-Group	Total - Persons	Total - Male	Total - Female	Illiterate - Persons	Illiterate - Male	Illiterate - Female	Literate - Persons	Literate - Male	Literate - Female
UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Dhodia	Total	0-6	3131	1569	1562	3131	1569	1562	0	0	0
90	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Dhodia	Total	7	462	242	220	91	48	43	371	194
91	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Dhodia	Total	8	446	229	217	46	20	26	400	209
92	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Dhodia	Total	9	355	165	190	14	5	9	341	160
93	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Dhodia	Total	10	463	229	234	24	10	14	439	219
94	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Dhodia	Total	11	375	202	173	11	4	7	364	198
95	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Dhodia	Total	12	472	219	253	17	2	15	455	217
96	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Dhodia	Total	13	466	227	239	19	1	18	447	226
97	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Dhodia	Total	14	413	198	215	17	4	13	396	194
351	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Kokna	Total	0-6	4354	2151	2203	4354	2151	2203	0	0
352	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Kokna	Total	7	505	255	250	188	79	109	317	176
353	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Kokna	Total	8	643	300	343	164	53	111	479	247
354	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Kokna	Total	9	538	242	296	81	17	64	457	225
355	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Kokna	Total	10	620	324	296	101	32	69	519	292
356	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Kokna	Total	11	442	237	205	43	12	31	399	225
357	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Kokna	Total	12	623	320	303	113	30	83	510	290
358	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Kokna	Total	13	497	251	246	90	19	71	407	232
359	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Kokna	Total	14	499	257	242	110	26	84	389	231
612	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Varli	Total	0-6	20505	10216	10289	20505	10216	10289	0	0
613	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Varli	Total	7	2429	1258	1171	1221	543	678	1208	713
614	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Varli	Total	8	3084	1550	1534	1203	464	739	1881	1086
615	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Varli	Total	9	2229	1136	1093	696	229	467	1533	907
616	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Varli	Total	10	3302	1641	1661	1318	416	902	1984	1225
617	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Varli	Total	11	1700	944	756	487	157	330	1213	787
618	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Varli	Total	12	2876	1518	1358	1156	377	779	1720	1141
619	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Varli	Total	13	1827	989	838	694	200	494	1133	789
620	UNION TERRITORY - DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI 26	Varli	Total	14	2050	1102	948	919	288	631	1131	814
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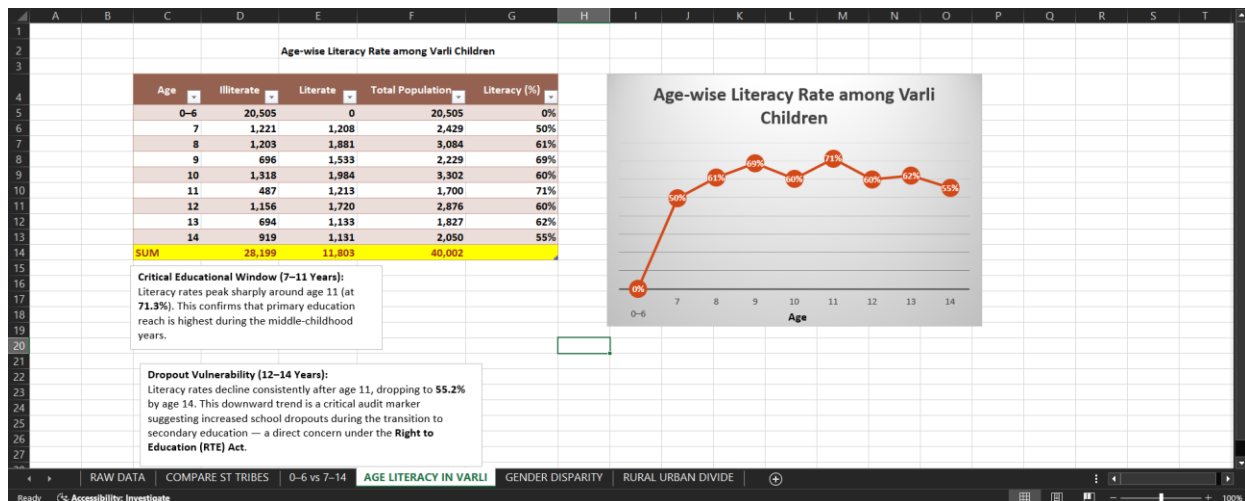
Appendix A: Raw Data sheet



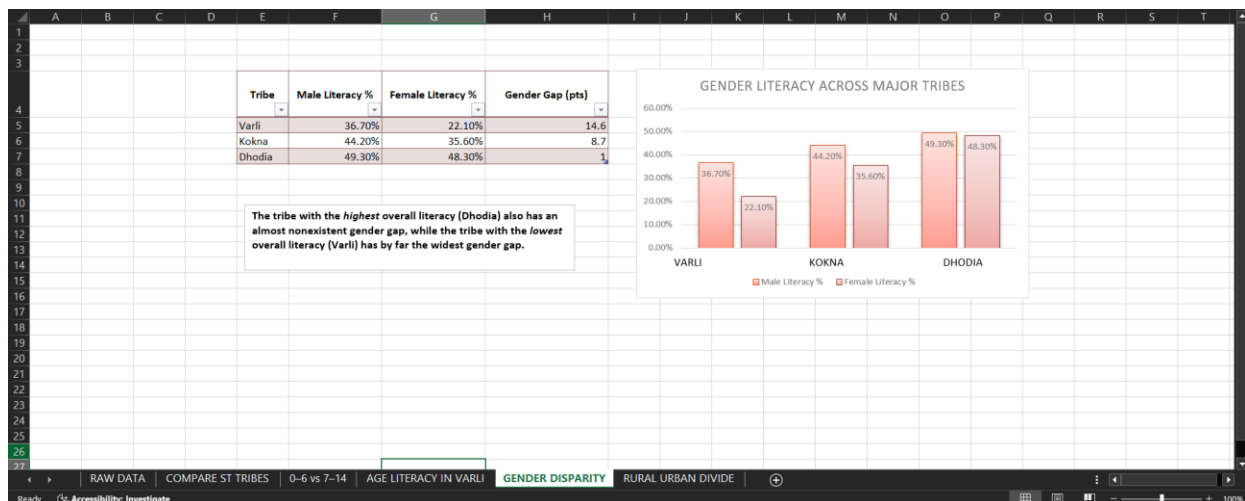
Appendix B: Compare ST Tribes sheet



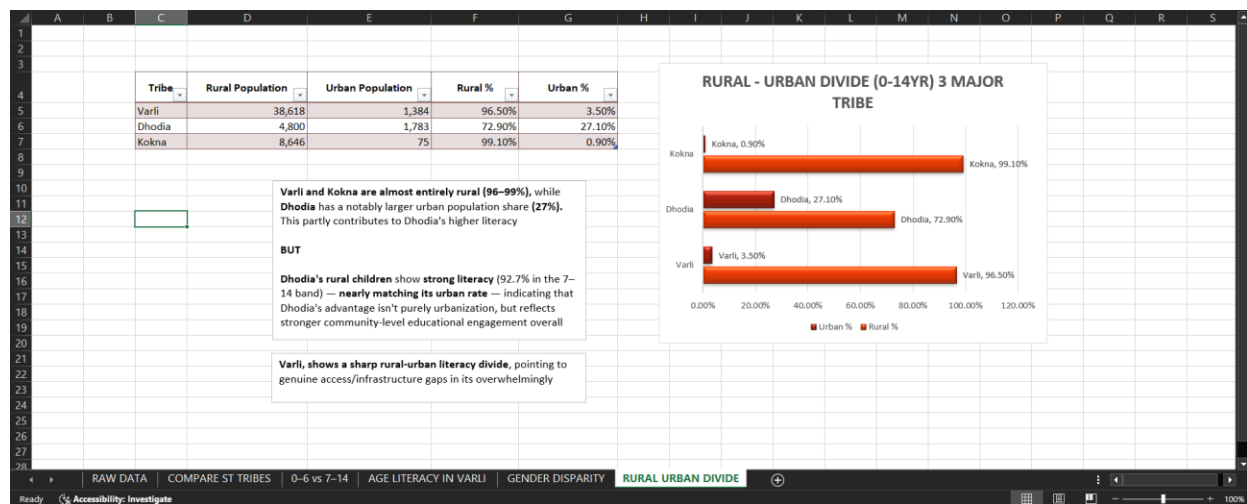
Appendix C: 0-6 vs 7-14 sheet



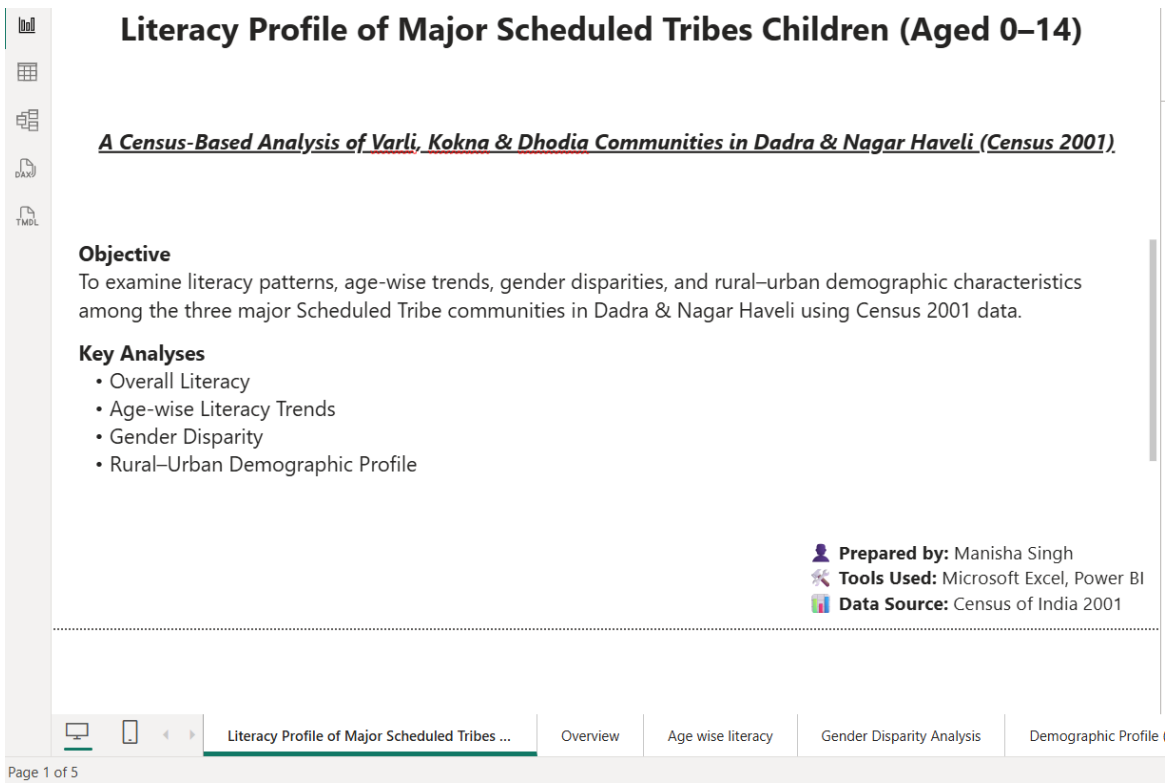
Appendix D: Age Literacy in Varli sheet



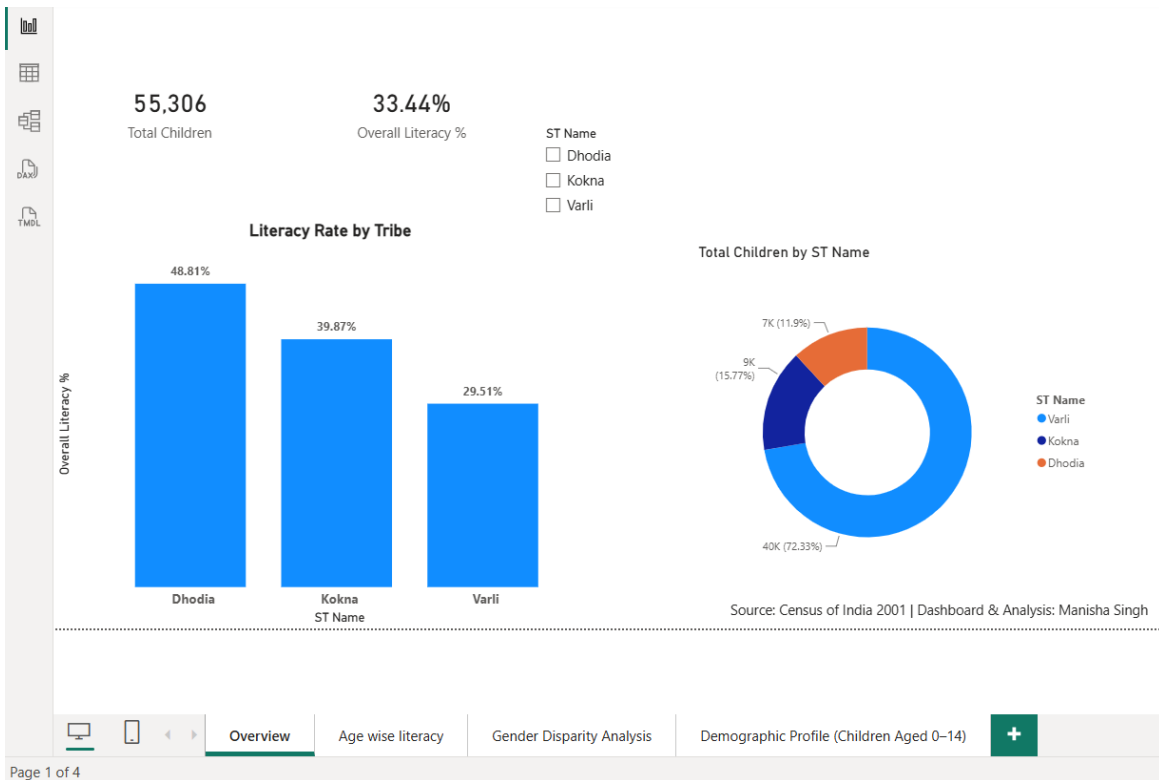
Appendix E: Gender Disparity sheet



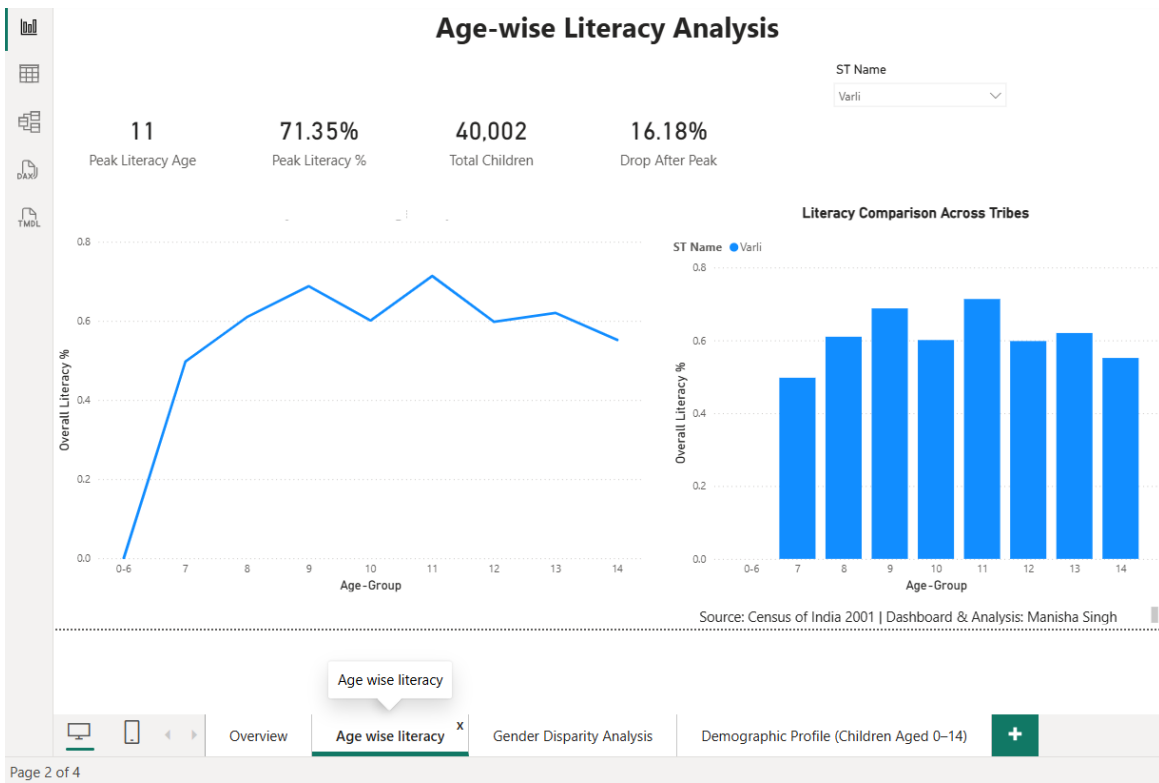
Appendix F: Rural Urban Divide sheet



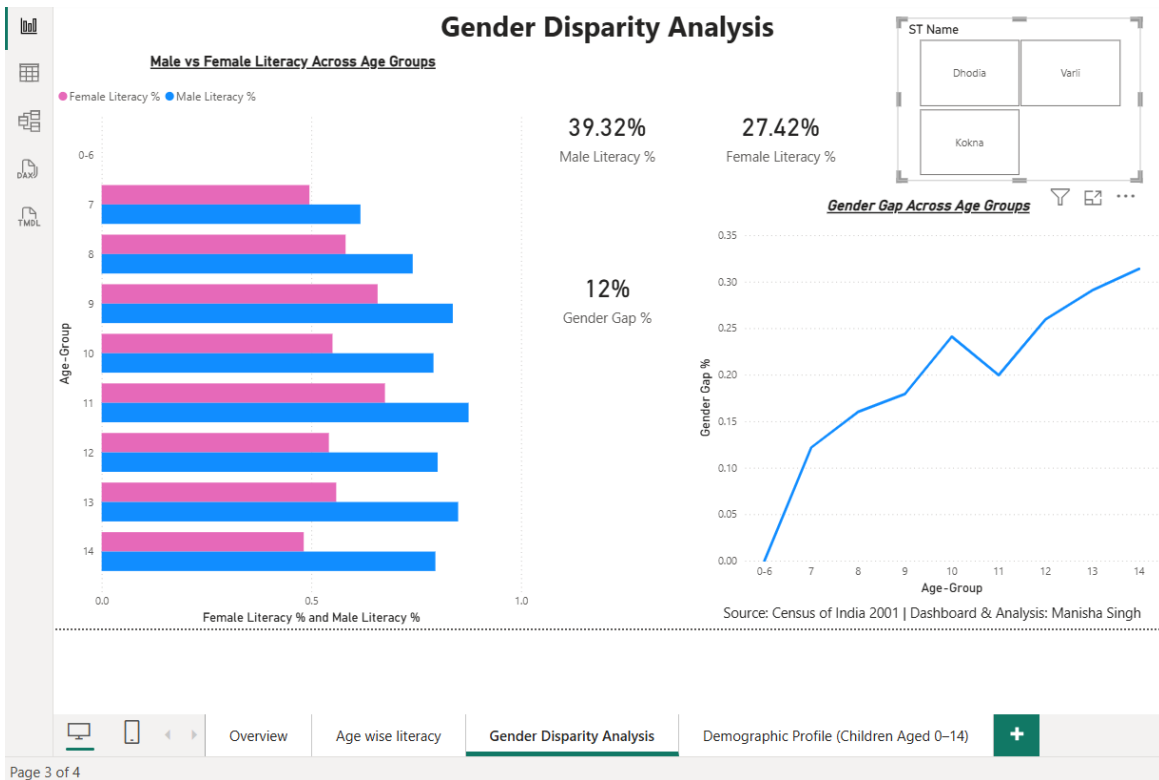
Appendix G: Power BI Dashboard — Title Page



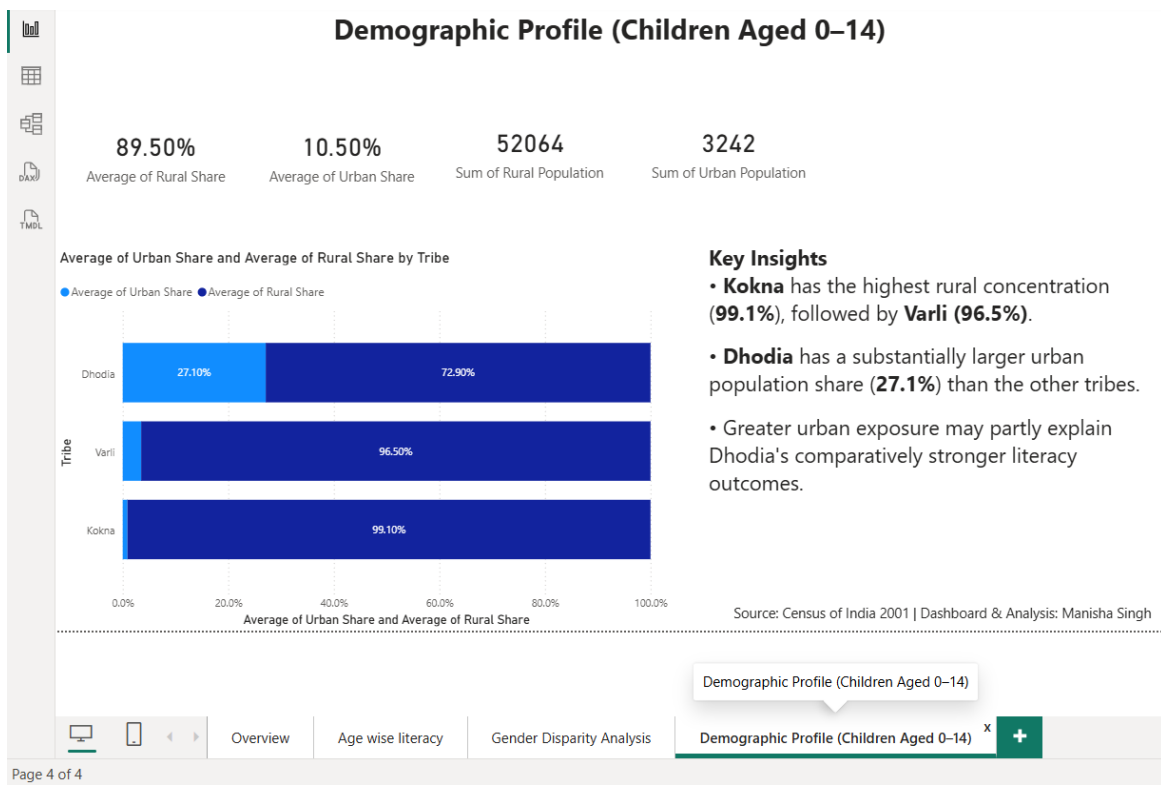
Appendix H: Power BI Dashboard — Overview Page



Appendix I: Power BI Dashboard — Age-wise Literacy Analysis



Appendix J: Power BI Dashboard — Gender Disparity Analysis



Appendix K: Power BI Dashboard — Demographic Profile